cell. Or what I was like. No situation nowadays can be considered immune from the celebrity-seeing eye, and soon there were whispers at the cell door. Whispers at volume. ‘Be careful who you speak to.’ ‘You’ll be okay.’ ‘Don’t trust anyone.’ ‘Don’t worry about anything.’

I felt I was in a kind of deviant’s *Barbarella*. I wanted to be out doing my work as a journalist, not stuck here playing the martyr, and my life’s training had made it impossible for me to stomach the bureaucratic hell of prison and the stigmatising horror of being reduced by blind authority. Every hour of your time in prison is a kind of guerrilla warfare against encroaching paperwork and stultifying rules. In just applying to buy a postage stamp you risk hypothermia in a snowstorm of forms. After they moved me to the separation unit, I continued with my campaign to make calls. It was Stalinist. It took me most of my time there to win a phone call to my lawyer. To make such a call you had to be calling an approved number on a previously submitted list of numbers and you had to have phone credit. There were two types of credit, domestic and foreign. Different forms for that. And the forms were both hard to get hold of and hard to get attended to. I filled in the same forms so many times that the process became like the case of Jarndyce and Jarndyce in *Bleak House*. Unending. I then had to supply the name, telephone number, address and birth date of the person I wanted to call. You had to fill out a form to get a PIN corresponding to your domestic telephone account and another PIN corresponding to your foreign account. It went from being a farce to being a nightmare to being a form of torture. The forms kept coming back and forth or being lost. Once you finally get to the phone you’re only allowed to speak for ten minutes. Then you can’t make another call for five minutes. They record all the calls except the ones made to lawyers, but further steps have to be taken to prove the speaker is a lawyer. As part of this approval effort the prison will only accept office numbers, not mobiles, despite the fact that lawyers spend their lives on mobiles. And so it goes on, a Kafkaesque miasma of passive aggression and hindrance.

In the end I got to speak to my mother and to my lawyer. I also tried to speak to Daniel Ellsberg, the man who brought the Pentagon Papers to the world. He wasn’t in. Turns out he was off chaining himself to the gates of the White House. (They removed his handcuffs to make it impossible.) ‘G’day, Dan,’ I said to his voicemail. ‘Just dropping you a note from the